

Monday, 13 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 28° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 27° 14°	MANCHESTER Mostly clear 27° 15°	GLASGOW Partly cloudy 21° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

A major incident has been declared after a mountain wildfire forced residents to evacuate their homes.

Firefighters are battling challenging conditions to contain the blaze, which has spread rapidly. Emergency services are on scene, working to protect properties and ensure public safety.

DISASTER · UK
- 2

A murder investigation has been launched after a woman was tragically stabbed in west London.

Police have arrested one person in connection with the incident. Another man was also injured during the attack. Officers are appealing for witnesses.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Two people have been charged after a man's body was discovered in a suitcase in woods in Kent.

A man from London faces a murder charge in connection with the grim discovery. Police are continuing their investigations. The victim's identity has not yet been released.

CRIME · UK
- 4

A lorry driver has been arrested after a child sadly died in a collision.

Detectives are urging any witnesses to the incident to come forward. The accident happened in an undisclosed location. Further details are expected to be released soon.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 5

A murder investigation is underway following the death of former MP Ann Widdecombe.

Ms Widdecombe was found dead at her home in Haytor, Devon, on Thursday morning. Police have not yet released details on the circumstances surrounding her death. More information is expected to follow.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 **Reading Festival has applied for permission to host main stage music on a fourth day this year.**
Currently, Wednesdays and Thursdays are considered warm-up days before the main weekend. This change could mean an even bigger festival experience. Organisers are awaiting approval for the extension.

ON AIR – Would you like an extra day of music at Reading Festival? Is it good value, or too much?
MUSIC · THIS WEEK

- 2 **The historic Bayeux Tapestry has arrived in the UK for the first time in 900 years, under police guard.**
This incredible 70-metre embroidery depicts events leading up to the Norman Conquest of England. It will go on public display in September. This is a truly once-in-a-lifetime opportunity to see it on British soil.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see the Bayeux Tapestry here in the UK for the first time in centuries? Will you be going?
ART · SEPTEMBER

- 3 **John Constable's iconic painting 'The Hay Wain' has arrived in Suffolk for the first time in its history.**
Despite depicting a Suffolk scene, the famous artwork has never actually been in the county until now. It's a fantastic opportunity for local art lovers to see the masterpiece in its spiritual home. It's expected to draw huge crowds.

ON AIR – Isn't it amazing that 'The Hay Wain' is finally in Suffolk? Have you ever seen a famous painting in person?
ART · THIS WEEK

- 4 **Pitbull fans have set a new world record, with 22,000 people wearing bald caps at his concert.**
Mr Worldwide's dedicated followers achieved the Guinness World Record for the largest gathering of people wearing bald caps. It was a truly unique and memorable sight. Pitbull himself seemed delighted by the tribute.

ON AIR – What's the most unusual thing you've seen a crowd do at a concert? Could you be persuaded to wear a bald cap for your favourite artist?
MUSIC · RECENT

- 5 **Melanie C has described the Spice Girls' 30th anniversary as 'emotional', reflecting on their incredible legacy.**
Sporty Spice picked up a global impact award in London, celebrating the group's enduring influence. Fans are still hoping for a full reunion tour. The Spice Girls remain one of the biggest British music acts of all time.

ON AIR – Can you believe it's been 30 years since the Spice Girls burst onto the scene? What's your favourite Spice Girls memory?
MUSIC · RECENT

On the schedule

1 **The World Cup semi-finals are set, with England facing Argentina and France taking on Spain in two huge clashes.**

These heavyweight encounters promise thrilling football and intense rivalries. Fans are eagerly anticipating the match-ups. It's all to play for as teams battle for a place in the final.

ON AIR – Which semi-final are you most looking forward to? Who do you think will make it to the final?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

2 **Lionel Messi is set to play against England for the very first time in the World Cup semi-final.**

Argentina beat Switzerland in extra-time to set up the clash, meaning Messi will finally face the Three Lions. It's a historic moment for football fans. All eyes will be on the legendary player.

ON AIR – Messi against England – it's a fixture we've waited years for! Do you think England's defence can contain him?

FOOTBALL · THIS WEEK

3 **Scrum-half Raffi Quirke has received an England call-up for Saturday's Nations Championship match against Argentina.**

It's a big opportunity for Quirke to impress on the international stage. The squad will be looking for a strong performance. Argentina will provide a tough test for England.

ON AIR – How do you think Raffi Quirke will perform for England against Argentina? Are you excited for the Nations Championship?

RUGBY · THIS WEEK

4 **Marc Marquez has dominated to win his tenth German MotoGP, with a commanding performance at the Sachsenring.**

The seven-times MotoGP world champion showed his class and experience once again. He delivered a truly dominant display. Marquez continues to be a force in the sport.

ON AIR – What an incredible achievement for Marc Marquez! Do you follow MotoGP, and who are your favourite riders?

MOTOR SPORT · RECENT

5 **Great Britain's Alfie Hewett was beaten in the Wimbledon men's wheelchair singles final by top seed Tokito Oda.**

Hewett put up a valiant effort but ultimately fell to a strong performance from Oda. Despite the loss, it was a fantastic tournament for the British player. He continues to be a leading light in the sport.

ON AIR – Alfie Hewett is such an inspiring athlete. What's been your favourite Wimbledon moment this year?

TENNIS · RECENT

Quick hits

- 1 The humble art of 'darning socks' is making a stylish comeback as a sustainable fashion statement.**
Instead of throwing away slightly worn items, more people are embracing visible mending, turning tiny holes into charming, colourful details. It's a lovely way to give old clothes a new lease of life and express a bit of creativity!
- 2 A surprising new study suggests that listening to 'nature sounds' like birdsong or waves can actually boost your mood and productivity.**
Researchers found that even a few minutes of natural audio can reduce stress and improve focus. Perhaps it's time to swap those busy tunes for something a little more calming.
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'writing a letter' is experiencing a quiet renaissance, with many rediscovering its unique charm.**
In a world of instant messages, the thoughtful act of putting pen to paper and sending something through the post feels more special than ever. It's a lovely way to connect with friends and family.
- 4 A delightful trend for 'identifying garden insects' is encouraging more people to observe the tiny wonders in their own backyards.**
From busy bees to colourful ladybirds, there's a whole world of fascinating creatures buzzing around. It's a wonderful way to learn about local wildlife and appreciate biodiversity.
- 5 The comforting appeal of 'baking your own bread' from scratch is flourishing across the nation.**
There's nothing quite like the smell of freshly baked bread wafting through the house, is there? More and more people are enjoying the therapeutic process and delicious results.
- 6 A charming movement encouraging 'swapping houseplants and cuttings' with neighbours is gaining popularity.**
It's a wonderful way to expand your indoor jungle, share green-fingered tips, and connect with your community. Plus, it's a very affordable way to get new plant varieties!
- 7 The unexpected joy of 'rediscovering old family photo albums' is bringing smiles and shared memories to households.**
There's something truly special about flipping through physical albums, spotting familiar faces and reliving moments from years gone by. It's a lovely trip down memory lane!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what with their laundry, even though they know it's a bit of a gamble?

ANSWER: LEAVING IT IN THE WASHING MACHINE FOR 'JUST A LITTLE BIT LONGER' BEFORE TAKING IT OUT.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'item of stationery' that they absolutely can't do without at work or home?

ANSWER: A SPECIFIC PEN THAT 'WRITES JUST RIGHT' AND NO OTHER WILL DO!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you find a 'forgotten item' in an old coat pocket or at the back of a drawer?**
What's the most surprising or delightful thing you've ever discovered that you'd completely forgotten about? Give us a call!

- **We all have those 'little habits' that make our journey to work or school just a bit smoother, don't we?**
Do you have a particular route you always take, a certain song you listen to, or a specific coffee shop you have to visit? We'd love to hear your commuting quirks!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain visible for millions of years because there is no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It is illegal to sing 'Happy Birthday' in public without paying royalties to the song's original copyright holders.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£7.6 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as three-dimensional wallpaper.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlllantysiliogogogoch, in Wales.
- Pineapples were once so rare and expensive in Europe that they were displayed as a symbol of wealth rather than eaten.
- The 'King's Guard' at Buckingham Palace wear bearskin hats that weigh about 7 pounds.
- The first modern Olympic Games were held in Athens, Greece, in 1896.
- Cats can make over 100 different sounds, whereas dogs can only make about 10.

On this day

Day 194 of the year, 171 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abd-al-Masih; Christian feast day: Abel of Tacla Haimonot (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Clelia Barbieri; Christian feast day: Conrad Weiser (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1963 — Neal Foulds, English snooker player and sportscaster
- 1979 — Craig Bellamy, Welsh footballer
- 1949 — Bryan Murray, Irish actor
- 1988 — Tulisa, English singer-songwriter and actress
- 1956 — Mark Mendoza, American bass player and songwriter
- 1992 — Rich the Kid, American rapper
- 1953 — Gil Birmingham, American actor
- 1957 — Cameron Crowe, American director, producer, and screenwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 2020 — After a five-day search, the body of American actress and singer Naya Rivera is recovered from Lake Piru in California, where she had drowned.
- 1973 — Watergate scandal: Alexander Butterfield reveals the existence of a secret Oval Office taping system to investigators for the Senate Watergate Committee.
- 2008 — Battle of Wanat begins when Taliban and al-Qaeda guerrillas attack US Army and Afghan National Army troops in Afghanistan. The U.S. deaths were, at that time, the most in a single battle since the beginning of operations in 2001.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1977 — Amidst a period of financial and social turmoil, New York City experiences an electrical blackout lasting nearly 24 hours that leads to widespread fires and looting.
- 1977 — Somalia declares war on Ethiopia, starting the Ogaden War.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1973 — Watergate scandal: Alexander Butterfield reveals the existence of a secret Oval Office taping system to investigators for the Senate Watergate Committee.

- 2016 — Prime Minister of the United Kingdom David Cameron resigns, and is succeeded by Theresa May.
- 2011 — United Nations Security Council Resolution 1999 is adopted, which admits South Sudan to member status of United Nations.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 195 of the year, 170 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Blessed Angeline of Marsciano; Christian feast day: Gaspar de Bono; Christian feast day: Camillus of Lellis (Roman Catholic Church, except in the United States); Christian feast day: Deusdedit of Canterbury. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1966 — Matthew Fox, American actor
- 1938 — Tommy Vig, Hungarian vibraphone player, drummer, and composer
- 1930 — Polly Bergen, American actress and singer (died 2014)
- 1932 — Del Reeves, American country singer-songwriter (died 2007)
- 1926 — Harry Dean Stanton, American actor, musician, and singer (died 2017)
- 1987 — Dan Reynolds, American singer-songwriter
- 1923 — Dale Robertson, American actor (died 2013)
- 1918 — Arthur Laurents, American director, screenwriter, and playwright (died 2011)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1902 — Peruvian explorer and farmer Agustín Lizárraga discovers Machu Picchu, the "Lost City of the Incas".
- 2002 — French president Jacques Chirac escapes an assassination attempt from Maxime Brunerie during a Bastille Day parade at Champs-Élysées.
- 1950 — Korean War: beginning of the Battle of Taejon.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1911 — Harry Atwood, an exhibition pilot for the Wright brothers, is greeted by president William Howard Taft after he lands his aeroplane on the South Lawn of the White House, having flown from Boston.
- 1916 — Battle of Delville Wood begins as an action within the Battle of the Somme, lasting until 3 September 1916.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)